

T Level Technical Qualification in Digital Software Development (Level 3)

Specimen Assessment Material

Time 3 hours

**Paper
reference**

XXXXXX/XX

Core: Employer Set Project

TASK 1: Planning a project

Task Booklet

You must have:

Task1_RBSX_ Project_Plan.xlsx

Information

- The total mark for this set task is 18.
- This booklet is specific to each series and this material must only be issued to students who have been entered to undertake the task in the relevant series.
- This booklet must be kept securely until the start of the timetabled assessment.

Continue ►

Instructions to Students

You must complete ALL parts of the activity within the assessment.

Read the assessment information carefully.

You must plan your time and submit all required evidence at the end of the supervised period.

The task must be undertaken at the time and on the date specified by Pearson.

You have **three hours** in total to complete this task.

Your provider will advise you of when any supervised breaks have been scheduled.

The task must be completed under supervised conditions.

During this task you are **not** permitted:

- to have access to the internet
- to use AI or any other tool designed to automate producing a solution.

You are permitted to use **offline** versions of relevant software to produce evidence for this task.

Files provided for use during this activity:

- *Task1_RBSX_Project_Plan.xlsx*

Your work and any material provided must be kept securely at all times.

Set Task Brief

You work for a digital systems development company that has been contracted by RBSX Group Ltd to plan and develop their new digital solution.

Your manager has asked you to:

- analyse the potential costs, benefits and risks associated
- produce a proposal and rationale for the development of the new digital solution.

Your manager has provided the spreadsheet file *Task1_RBSX_Project_Plan.xlsx* containing:

- a summary of the project information
- a Gantt chart template
- a staff cost calculator.

Activity

Produce a project plan which contains:

- a Gantt chart to demonstrate how you would organise the development of the new digital solution
- a plan for the resources selected and associated costs, exploring the affordability of implementing the project and the impact it will have on company profits over the next three years.

Produce a rationale that explains notable planning decisions including:

- choices made on the order of tasks, considering any dependencies or prerequisites
- allocation of tasks to members of staff
- any potential benefits or risks you had to consider
- the impact of planning decisions on the final timings and costs of the project
- justification of the decisions you made.

Use the Set Task Information, Planning Information and project plan template when completing this activity.

(Total for Task 1 = 18 marks)

Outcomes for Submission

Save your project plan as an .xlsx file.

Save your rationale as a PDF file.

All files should be saved in your folder for submission.

Use this naming convention:

- *Task1_DSD_ProjectPlan_[Registration number]_[surname]_[first letter of first name]*
- *Task1_DSD_Rationale_[Registration number]_[surname]_[first letter of first name]*

Set Task Information

RBSX Group Ltd is an organisation that provides financial advice services to customers in the UK. The organisation currently relies on its advisers travelling to meet its clients in person.

After a review of its current digital solutions, the organisation has decided that it needs to develop a new digital solution.

The aims of the new digital solution are to enable:

- staff to engage with stakeholders and support clients more effectively
- management to access tools to carry out business data analysis
- clients to access tools to manage their investments and savings.

The requirements of the system are:

- to provide two-way communication between staff and clients
- to allow staff and clients to interact with a dashboard of relevant financial information
- to provide up-to-date information about financial products and services
- to provide an appropriate user interface.

Planning information

RBSX Group Ltd has forecast that developing the new digital solution will lead to:

- an increase in average annual income of 8.75% after the system has been in place for one year
- an additional increase of 15.5% after two years
- an additional increase of 13% after three years.

The management team knows that there will be an increase in outgoing costs as a result of the new system.

RBSX Group Ltd and your manager have provided you with information to help you produce your plan.

Financial information for the project	
Description of the income/costs	Amount (£)
Current annual income	1 580 900
Current annual total costs	985 340
Forecast costs for the new digital solution	Amount (£)
Software development company base fee	50 000
Cost of training and development of RBSX staff	4 000
Cost of equipment upgrades (laptops, workstations etc.)	15 000
Cost of software licensing	4 000
Cost of new server	Option 1 – hosted cloud-based server – 830 (per month, ongoing) Option 2 – physical server 13 500 (single payment)
Cost of infrastructure (networking) upgrades	13 200
Project manager's pay (you)	200 per day
Forecast ongoing annual costs	Amount (£)
Additional network technician	22 000
Maintenance costs (server, equipment, infrastructure)	9 250

The senior managers have allocated five members of staff to work on this project.

Your project development team will consist of:

- One senior software engineer (current employee):
 - Sarah O'Toole
- Two junior software engineers (new employees):
 - Ahad Shafiq
 - Terry Duran
- One database engineer (current employee):
 - Gina Diaz
- One network engineer (current employee):
 - Marius Bronski.

Profiles for the Staff

Name	Sarah O'Toole
Job title	Senior software engineer
Core Skills	• Able to program in Python and C# • Trained in a range of software-testing methods • Specialises in developing front-end systems • Limited back-end development experience
Previous experience	• 10 years' experience of delivering solutions for large multinational corporations in the financial sector • Developed cloud-deployed solutions in the financial sector • Highly experienced in leading software development teams on high-risk projects
Cost	£105 per hour

Name	Ahad Shafiq
Job title	Junior software engineer
Core Skills	• Specialises in web-based solutions including use of HTML/CSS, JavaScript and SQL • Completed modules in Human Computer Interaction (HCI) while studying for their degree
Previous experience	• Newly graduated from university – no previous work experience
Cost	£25 per hour

Name	Terry Duran
Job title	Junior software engineer
Core Skills	• Specialises in Kotlin and Java • Good knowledge of Python 3, JavaScript • Excellent communication skills, both written and verbal • The ability to explain complicated processes in non-technical language
Previous experience	• 4 years' experience as an independent mobile app developer • Significant experience in the computer game development sector
Cost	£45 per hour

Name	Gina Diaz
Job title	Database engineer
Core Skills	• Specialises in PHP, Python 3 and SQL • In-depth understanding of system security • Significant experience developing back-end solutions • Good team-working skills
Previous experience	• Experience of delivering local and cloud-deployed database systems in the retail industry
Cost	£47.50 per hour

Name	Marius Bronski
Job title	Network engineer
Core Skills	• Excellent at problem-solving and troubleshooting network problems to maximise network performance • Specialises in planning, implementing and monitoring computer networks • Experienced in analysing and improving system security • A comprehensive knowledge of network protocols and services
Previous experience	• Experience of installing networks and other infrastructure in the retail and entertainment industries
Cost	£73 per hour

Your manager has produced an outline of the key tasks that need to be completed during the project. The table shows the key tasks and the estimated number of work hours it will take to complete each task.

Key task	Estimated number of work hours
Upgrade infrastructure	21
Install physical server	7
Develop module – Investments and savings	115
Develop module – User interface	70
Develop module – Information feed	126
Develop module – Back-end database	147
Develop module – Data analytics	112
Develop module – Communications	105
Deploy modules	7 (per module)
Unit testing	21 (per module)
Integration testing	14 (per module)
Fixing and regression testing for major fault	14 (per fault found)
Fixing and regression testing for minor fault	7 (per fault found)
User/acceptance testing	35
Create a test plan	14
Training RBSX staff to use new system	21

It is assumed that:

- at least three minor faults will be found with each module
- no more than three major faults will be found throughout the whole project
- each member of staff will work 7 hours a day, 5 days a week
- there will be no staff absences during the project development.

RBSX Group Ltd has requested that the project is completed in **17 weeks**.

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